GRADE 12 / Business Studies / English

Match a strategy to the challenge

01 Understand

Learning goals: Distinguish internal and external SWOT factors • Choose a strategy from evidence • Justify and evaluate a recommendation

Strengths and weaknesses are internal; opportunities and threats are external. A SWOT list should use specific evidence.

Strategy responds to the business situation. Options may include development, integration, diversification or defensive measures, depending on the case.

An exam response needs a clear recommendation and application to the scenario. Consider affordability, risk and likely outcomes rather than assuming expansion always works.

SWOT for an illustrative tutoring publisher

Internal strengths	Internal weaknesses	External factors
Strong maths authors	Slow delivery process	Opportunity: digital demand
Clear brand identity	Limited cash reserves	Threat: new competitors

02 Follow the reasoning

The publisher has strong authors but slow delivery and little cash. Recommend a cautious response to demand for digital notes.

1. Use the author strength to pilot a small digital product rather than attempting every subject immediately.

2. A pilot can reduce delivery delays and limit upfront costs, but requires editing and reliable access.

3. Evaluate download completion, learner feedback and contribution to costs before expanding.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Classify a cash shortage in SWOT.

2. Classify a new competitor offering free content.

3. Give two criteria for evaluating the digital pilot.

04 Check and correct

1. Weakness: an internal resource limitation.

2. Threat: an external competitive influence.

3. For example, completed downloads and learner usefulness ratings; also compare costs with revenue or funding.

Common mistake to avoid

Naming a strategy earns little without explaining why it addresses the specific challenge in the case.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Business environments: business strategies; SWOT analysis

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Business Studies. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID bst-12.